

Kamal Joshi

Staff Software Engineer | Go | AWS | Distributed Systems | SaaS Platforms | AI-Assisted Engineering

Austin, TX | Open to remote

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff-level software engineer and technical leader with deep experience building production-grade SaaS infrastructure, distributed systems, and platform services. Proven track record of leading high-stakes projects from ambiguity to launch — aligning stakeholders, making tough architectural trade-offs, and ensuring long-term system health. Act as a force multiplier for engineering teams: mentoring early-in-career engineers, championing clean architecture, and pioneering tooling adoption that raises the team's collective velocity. I proactively use AI-assisted engineering in my daily workflow — not just as a tool, but as a discipline: I own the design, the quality bar, and the business outcome while directing AI to produce safe, testable, maintainable code across the full SDLC.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **Distributed systems & SaaS platform engineering:** Go, Java, Spring Boot, gRPC, REST/JSON APIs, webhooks, CloudEvents, event-driven microservices, service-oriented architectures
- **Cloud services:** AWS (Lambda, ECS, EKS, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, Secrets Manager), Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- **Technical leadership:** architectural decision-making, system design, cross-functional stakeholder alignment, production ownership, incident response
- **Force multiplier:** mentoring engineers, code review, knowledge-sharing culture, internal library development
- **AI-assisted development:** daily use of Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, and Codex — implementation, IaC, test generation, debugging, and code review; pioneered team-wide Copilot adoption
- **Full-stack breadth:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Angular; API-driven UI workflows; secure coding practices

EXPERIENCE

Cisco

Software Engineering Technical Leader

November 2025 - May 2026 | Austin, TX

- Led architectural design and delivery of production-grade SaaS platform services for Cisco Secure Access, owning the **API Gateway**, **Authorization Service**, and **Third-Party Integrations Service** — from discovery through production ownership.
- Navigated a high-stakes, ambiguous project from initial design to **alpha delivery on schedule (Nov 2025)** with a team of three engineers — leading the push security events capability using the CloudEvents standard, a long-awaited product feature.
- Prevented production data loss by identifying a **300k+ message DLQ backlog**, quantifying impact across **15 organizations**, and redriving all messages within **5-10 minutes** — end-to-end ownership of a critical production incident.
- Resolved a customer-scale onboarding failure by tracing **250+ appliance registration requests** across API key authentication and rate-limit behavior, driving durable fixes around retry/backoff, token reuse, and service ownership.
- Reframed API onboarding as a control-plane architecture problem and proposed a hybrid model that improved self-service speed while preserving auditability — **influencing the product roadmap** through technical clarity.
- Drove multi-region HA rollout and sovereign environment production readiness by decomposing high-risk Terraform changes into staged rollouts across ECR, Secrets Manager, DynamoDB streams, SNS, service config, and audit logging.

- Diagnosed and fixed a Jamf / Intune integration issue live during a prospective customer evaluation, **contributing directly to the customer's purchase decision.**

Senior Software Engineer

January 2021 - November 2025 | Austin, TX

- Built **auth-tools**, an internal authorization library adopted across multiple platform services — a deliberate investment in long-term maintainability and reduced integration friction.
- Acted as a force multiplier: mentored early-in-career engineers through code review, design feedback, and pairing; initiated **Tip Talk Tue**, a recurring knowledge-sharing forum on engineering productivity and security practices.
- Pioneered team-wide **GitHub Copilot** adoption ahead of broader Cisco AI initiatives; integrated Claude Code and Codex into daily workflows, advancing the team from passive consumers to active practitioners of AI-assisted development.
- Led **ISMAP security certification** for the APIX platform end-to-end, coordinating cross-functional compliance requirements and meeting all deadlines.

Randstad Technologies US at Cisco

Senior Software Developer

March 2015 - January 2021 | Dublin, OH

- Designed and implemented **Go-based gRPC and JSON/HTTP APIs** for a cloud-native data ingestion platform; built OIDC/OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorization flows.
- Contributed to automatic generation of protocol buffer specs from SQL schemas, improving API consistency and reducing repetitive implementation work.
- Designed a type-assisted search feature for an Active Threat Analytics dashboard, turning complex querying into a low-friction workflow for security analysts.
- Reduced **100+ OWASP-reported security warnings to zero** through secure coding, browser security headers, input sanitization, and server-side validation.

Earlier Engineering Experience

Cognizant, Oracle, Collabera | December 2007 - February 2015

- Delivered backend services, workflow applications, and integrations across financial services, healthcare, insurance, and public-sector SaaS products.
- Built a foundation in Java, REST APIs, service integrations, and maintainable engineering practices.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- MongoDB Certified Java Developer M101J
- Google Cloud Platform Essentials

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering, Information Technology
Dharmsinh Desai University